Contact

founder@nexuspacific.org

www.linkedin.com/in/andrewjkoch1980 (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Management Consulting
Defense Contracting
U.S.–China Strategic Competition

Andrew Koch

Founder & Managing Partner | Nexus Pacific | U.S.–Japan Defense & Dual-Use Strategy | Former USG
Tokyo, Japan

Summary

I founded Nexus Pacific to help U.S. defense and dual-use startups navigate Japan's evolving defense market and support Japanese startups seeking traction with U.S. venture capital and national security partners.

The firm specializes in market intelligence, stakeholder mapping, and engagement strategy tailored to the realities of Japan's defense innovation transformation.

We operate at the intersection of technology, diplomacy, and procurement—translating high-potential innovation into credible market entry.

Based in Tokyo with access to Japanese government agencies, defense companies, and U.S. Embassy channels, Nexus Pacific works with:
– U.S. companies pursuing market entry
– VCs scouting emerging Japanese startups in defense, AI, and dual-use tech
– Japanese startups preparing to meet U.S. investor expectations and DoD alignment requirements

The goal is not just to engage—but to gain traction where it matters.

Experience

Nexus Pacific
1 year

Founder & Managing Partner
June 2025 - Present (7 months)
Tokyo, Japan

Leading Nexus Pacific's expansion to support Japanese commercial technology firms exploring dual-use applicability and pursuing entry into the U.S. defense market. I advise clients on U.S. acquisition trends, validate alignment with Department of Defense priorities, and map actionable pathways across both grant and contract channels—including SBIR/STTR, OTAs, DIU solicitations, and targeted prime integrations.

Recent engagements include:
– Assessing defense relevance of Japanese commercial technology firms
– Advising on end-user and use-case alignment to meet DoD customer expectations
– Connecting clients to U.S. VC, integrators, and acquisition sponsors to accelerate traction

This phase reflects a sharpened bilateral focus: helping Japanese firms understand U.S. defense norms, while continuing to support U.S. clients navigating Japan's procurement, VC, and strategic ecosystems.

Founder
January 2025 - June 2025 (6 months)
Tokyo, Japan

Founded Nexus Pacific to help U.S. defense and dual-use startups engage Japan's national security and innovation stakeholders. Delivered tailored market entry strategy, stakeholder mapping, and strategic engagement plans for firms targeting Japan's procurement ecosystem.

This foundational phase established the firm's reputation with U.S. and Japanese clients, setting the stage for expanded bilateral work.

RAINCLOUD DEFENSE
RAINCLOUD Ambassador to Japan
June 2025 - Present (7 months)
Tokyo, Japan

Appointed as RAINCLOUD DEFENSE's Japan Ambassador to support the platform's expansion into the Japanese defense innovation ecosystem. In this role, I draw on my leadership of Nexus Pacific—a Tokyo-based advisory focused on dual-use market entry across the U.S. and Japan—to help RAINCLOUD users navigate government engagement, stakeholder alignment, and procurement opportunities.

I advise U.S. and allied startups on entering Japan's defense and dual-use markets, and work closely with Japanese commercial tech firms to assess U.S. defense applicability, identify viable contract vehicles, and pursue DoD acquisition pathways. My support spans market intelligence, strategic introductions, and alignment with national security priorities on both sides of the Pacific.

Self-employed
Independent Strategic Advisor / Venture Builder
September 2023 - December 2024 (1 year 4 months)
Tokyo, Japan

Following my departure from government service, I focused on mapping the Indo-Pacific defense innovation landscape—examining institutional dynamics, dual-use venture funding models, and emerging gaps between policy and execution. During this period, I advised early-stage startups on how to approach government engagement and assess the viability of expansion into Japan. These experiences laid the strategic foundation for launching Nexus Pacific, with a focus on helping trusted technologies gain traction through stakeholder alignment, credible entry strategies, and cross-border partnerships.

U.S. Department of State
U.S. Consulate Hong Kong
September 2020 - August 2023 (3 years)

Focused on U.S.–China strategic competition, defense policy, and technology diplomacy. This role directly informed my current work at the intersection of national security, emerging technologies, and allied innovation strategy.

United States Federal Government
Liaison to the FBI (Midwest Field Offices)
April 2018 - August 2020 (2 years 5 months)
Chicago Field Office

USG support to FBI CT investigations for 10 Field Offices across 9 Midwest states.

New York City Police Department
Counterterrorism Bureau
November 2016 - April 2018 (1 year 6 months)

Supported terrorism investigations and threat mitigation efforts as part of NYPD's Counterterrorism Bureau.

United States Federal Government
Counterterrorism Strategy and Operational Planning
February 2010 - August 2016 (6 years 7 months)

Developed, coordinated and supported interagency counterterrorism strategies and operations on behalf of the White House National Security Council.

U.S. Department of State
U.S. Embassy Algiers
September 2012 - November 2013 (1 year 3 months)

CT strategic and operational planning for the Maghreb and Sahel during the Arab Spring.

Booz Allen Hamilton
Senior Consultant
June 2006 - January 2010 (3 years 8 months)

Management consultant to USG clients.

New York City Council
Legislative Director
September 2002 - June 2005 (2 years 10 months)

Education

Columbia | SIPA
Master's Degree, International Affairs and Security Policy

New York University
Bachelor of Arts - BA, Political Science and Government